

SLUSH POOL

011 / 27 NOV 2010 / BITCOIN / UNCOMMON

POOL WORK. SHARE REWARDS.

Two muddy pigs work red and green pumps in a lantern-lit shed. Their pipes feed one glowing Bitcoin machine, whose side chutes drop coins into matching buckets. A third pig has chosen the mud bath instead. Its blue bucket sits empty beneath the silent middle chute. The joke is about joining the work, not simply joining the pool.

On 27 November 2010, Marek Palatinus, known as Slush, posted a proposal for cooperative Bitcoin mining. A small miner using CPUs could work for weeks without finding a block, while faster graphics cards were becoming common. His idea was to let separate computers ask one server for work, so their efforts could contribute to a shared attempt. His post ended with a simple question: “Are you interested in?”

Finding a block would bring a 50 BTC reward in 2010. Pool members would receive portions based on the work they contributed, exchanging the occasional large solo win for smaller, more frequent payments. Pooling did not make an individual computer magically faster. It reduced the uncertainty of when its owner would see a reward. The plan also required miners to trust the pool operator to distribute coins fairly, a tradeoff Slush acknowledged openly.

The card dates the public proposal to 27 November, while Braiins dates the pool's operational launch to 16 December 2010. The pigs, pumps, machine and muddy pool are fictional metaphors, not portraits or a reconstruction of the actual equipment. POOL WORK. SHARE REWARDS. is an editorial caption. The empty blue bucket makes participation visible; it is not a claim that taking a break erases rewards already earned.

HIDDEN IN THE ART

01 ONE SHARED MACHINE

Pipes from the red and green pumps feed the same Bitcoin-marked machine. It turns coordinated computing into a physical image; the brass apparatus is imaginary, not historical mining hardware.

02 WORK AND REWARDS

Coins fall from the outer chutes into the red and green buckets, matching the two working pigs. They stand for rewards linked to contributed work, not a literal payout formula or guaranteed equal amounts.

03 THE EMPTY BLUE BUCKET

No coins fall from the middle chute into the blue bucket. Its colour links it to the resting pig: an intentional joke about not contributing, not a record of a real unpaid miner.

04 A DIFFERENT KIND OF POOL

The blue-helmeted pig lounges happily in a pool of mud while the others pump. The literal pool plays on the name; the characters are fictional and do not portray Slush or his miners.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Slush's original forum proposal, 27 November 2010; Braiins' pool history, which dates the operational launch to 16 December 2010. The workshop, pigs, pumps, glowing machine, physical coins and buckets are illustrative fiction. The empty blue bucket is a contribution joke, not a rule forfeiting previously earned rewards. The caption is editorial wording, not a historical quotation.